The Study of the End Times (20)

Jacob Lannom / General Adult

Chapter 12 introduced to some end time players that really have been around for a lot longer than just the end.

We have the Woman who symbolizes Israel.

This Woman gives birth to a Son who is Jesus Christ.

We then have the Red Dragon who symbolizes Satan.

There is a war in heaven between the Red Dragon and his army and Micheal the Archangel and the angelic army. Satan can not win against the power of Micheal and the angels so they cast him out of heaven.

He then moves to persecute the Woman, but God protected her. He then tries to make war against the believers on the earth.

We see this in Revelation 12:17

Revelation 12:17 KJV 1900

17 And the dragon was wroth with the woman, and went to make war with the remnant of her seed, which keep the commandments of God, and have the testimony of Jesus Christ

We move right into Chapter 13 where we learn of more end time players.

The first of which is The Beast from the Sea…

Revelation 13:1–10 KJV 1900

1 And I stood upon the sand of the sea, and saw a beast rise up out of the sea, having seven heads and ten horns, and upon his horns ten crowns, and upon his heads the name of blasphemy.

2 And the beast which I saw was like unto a leopard, and his feet were as *the feet* of a

bear, and his mouth as the mouth of a lion: and the dragon gave him his power, and his seat, and great authority.

[3] And I saw one of his heads as it were wounded to death; and his deadly wound was healed: and all the world wondered after the beast.

[4] And they worshipped the dragon which gave power unto the beast: and they worshipped the beast, saying, Who *is* like unto the beast? who is able to make war with him?

[5] And there was given unto him a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies; and power was given unto him to continue forty *and* two months.

[6] And he opened his mouth in blasphemy against God, to blaspheme his name, and his tabernacle, and them that dwell in heaven.

[7] And it was given unto him to make war with the saints, and to overcome them: and power was given him over all kindreds, and tongues, and nations.

[8] And all that dwell upon the earth shall worship him, whose names are not written in the book of life of the Lamb slain from the foundation of the world.

[9] If any man have an ear, let him hear.

[10] He that leadeth into captivity shall go into captivity: he that killeth with the sword must be killed with the sword. Here is the patience and the faith of the saints.

Pray.

Now, we have briefly gone over some of the details in this chapter prior to tonight, but we will make sure to get all we can out of it now.

The dragon, Satan is standing on the seashore as this beast comes up from out of the sea.

There is more to this than meets the eye. The seashore includes the “sand of the sea” which represents the multitudes of humanity comprising the nations.

Satan standing on the seashore indicates his position of power and dominion over the earth. Especially in this second half of the Tribulation.

Let's think about this…before Creation, before the fall when sin corrupted the earth, before civilization, before culture, before nations and tongues…who hovered over the waters?

The Holy Spirit.

Genesis 1:1–2 KJV 1900

[1] In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.

[2] And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness *was* upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters.

Now we see Satan, the epitome of a fallen creation, the crux of what it looks like to fall into sin and completely out out of grace. He now stands on the seashore.

I like this description of what is going on here in this text from the International Theological Commentary…

Where God's Spirit once hovered over the waters to bring forth a fruitful, orderly world, the dragon now stands beside the sea to summon forth an infernal, demonic counterfeit creation

So now, what comes out of the sea?

A beast, with ten horns and seven heads, with ten diadems with blasphemous names upon his heads.

This is very close to the description we get of the Red Dragon himself from chapter 12.

The difference we see is that this beast seems =even more royal than the dragon. It has 10 diadems rather than 7.

We then see this beast compared to certain animals like a leopard, bear and lion. Our minds should immediately go to Daniel 7. These animals are connected to conquering

nations of old. Specifically, Greece, Medo-Persia and Babylon.

But it seems that instead of separate beasts, here they all combine to make one monster.

Notice also this beast has blasphemous names on its heads. This indicates claims to divine status. It is the same thing Roman emperors used and demanded to be called. Names like “Lord” and “Savior”

What does this beast or monster represent? Political, military and economic power.

Now, there is much speculation and debate on who this beast actually is. Many scholars claim that this is a revived Roman Empire. And it is hard to argue that perspective. The readers of Revelation in John’s day would have had no doubt that this beast was the Roman Empire that held political, economical and military power over basically the whole world at the time.

But it is also important to understand that this beast had to be an individual as well.

Look again at Revelation 13:3-4

Revelation 13:3–4 KJV 1900

3 And I saw one of his heads as it were wounded to death; and his deadly wound was healed: and all the world wondered after the beast.

4 And they worshipped the dragon which gave power unto the beast: and they worshipped the beast, saying, Who *is* like unto the beast? who is able to make war with him?

Although the beast symbolized corrupted political power, it is obvious that the monster here transforms into an individual.

This beast is wounded but then healed and all the world marveled at its healing.

This beast can be understood as being the antichrist. It is the dragon, that is the devil, gives him certain powers.

What is the responses of most in the world at this time? They worshipped not only the

dragon, Satan, but also the beast.

We may think in our minds, how in the world could anyone worship someone like satan, and even further than that worship what the Bible obviously describes as a monster?

Church, this should not come as a surprise to anyone. Did you know that there are 38 Satanist congregations in the world…well, that is not that many…that is just the ones that the IRS and Federal Courts recognize.

The headquarters for this wicked cult is in Salem, Massachusetts.

Listen to me…this cult has inly been around officially since 2013. I would say the growth is significant.

As a matter of fact, do you know what one of the most frequent responses I get when I ask about doing things in the schools for the Lord?

Well, if we let you do this we would have to let the satanists come in as well…I wish I could tell you they were joking.

Ever heard of the Good News Club? Immanuel here in town does a great job sharing the Gospel with young kiddos after school hours.

FCA? Fellowship of Christian Athletes…

There is also the ASSC's…this club has legally as much right to operate outside of school hours as FCA and Good News Club…what does ASSC stand for?

After School Satan Clubs. Let me repeat that.

Chapters and club proposals have appeared in Ohio, Pennsylvania, Texas and right here in TN. Although most school boards resist them in the schools, they typically have a standing to be able to take it to court.

Why does this matter. This is just what you would call an official Satan worshipping cult. What about all the non official ones?

As the day draws near, pay attention. If you don't think Satan worship is prevalent in Hollywood and other mainstream places, you are not looking close enough.

Another so called organization that is simply a cult that worships Satan is Planned Parenthood. Folks, baby sacrifice has been around for a long time. We have just commercialized it in America.

Do not underestimate the readiness for those who reject Jesus to receive the devil.

This is was Satan has always desired…

Isaiah 14:14 NASB95

14 'I will ascend above the heights of the clouds; I will make myself like the Most High.'

The devil must give the beats significant power because look at how the people praise him…

Revelation 13:4 KJV 1900

4 And they worshipped the dragon which gave power unto the beast: and they worshipped the beast, saying, Who *is* like unto the beast? who is able to make war with him?

Let's continue…

Revelation 13:5–6 KJV 1900

5 And there was given unto him a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies; and power was given unto him to continue forty *and* two months.

6 And he opened his mouth in blasphemy against God, to blaspheme his name, and his tabernacle, and them that dwell in heaven.

This beast goes around attempting to defame and slander the name of God. His intent is to destroy God's reputation. He does this for 42 months.

This is the final period of the Tribulation. We see this in 2 Thessalonians 2:4

2 Thessalonians 2:3–4 NASB95

[3] Let no one in any way deceive you, for *it will not come* unless the apostasy comes first, and the man of lawlessness is revealed, the son of destruction,

[4] who opposes and exalts himself above every so-called god or object of worship, so that he takes his seat in the temple of God, displaying himself as being God.

Will this work? Well, let me ask you something…what do we fight most about in our political environment today?

We argue, fight and get enraged over what people SAY. It is almost pathetic how we allow words spoken by known liars affect us so much.

And think about all that has happened already up to this point. It would not be too difficult to completely turn the people's hearts away from the true God.

This is a sign of the end times nearing anyway…

1 Timothy 4:1–2 NASB95

[1] But the Spirit explicitly says that in later times some will fall away from the faith, paying attention to deceitful spirits and doctrines of demons,

[2] by means of the hypocrisy of liars seared in their own conscience as with a branding iron,…

But this verbal assault turns physical…

Revelation 13:7 KJV 1900

[7] And it was given unto him to make war with the saints, and to overcome them: and power was given him over all kindreds, and tongues, and nations.

he will abolish all religions and force one religion…him.

Satanism will not be growing…it will be the only accpeted religion on the earth. This will create a fiery furnace situation for believers in God on the earth.

Obviously at this time, true believers will be a significant minority.

Revelation 13:8 KJV 1900

[8] And all that dwell upon the earth shall worship him, whose names are not written in the book of life of the Lamb slain from the foundation of the world.

I like this explanation from the Holman NT Commentary

Revelation **A. The Water Monster—Political Evil Incarnated (13:1–10)**

As if to make the contrast between the monster (slain and healed) and the Lamb even more stark, this is the Lamb slain from the creation of the world. Here is John's further observation dealing with the problem of evil. Although God has allowed evil, yet from the beginning he planned the ultimate remedy for overcoming evil: the sacrificial death of his Son. The slaughtered monster's evils will run rampant only for a short period of time. The consummation will reveal the slaughtered Lamb's victory and rule for eternity. Planned from the creation of the world, his kingdom will endure forever and ever.

Revelation 13:9–10 **NASB95**

[9] If anyone has an ear, let him hear.

[10] If anyone *is destined* for captivity, to captivity he goes; if anyone kills with the sword, with the sword he must be killed. Here is the perseverance and the faith of the saints.

It is by the steadfastness of the saints even in the midst of terrible and intense persecution, that their faith is shown true.

That truth is the same today. We cannot compare what is going on today with what will happen in the end, but when life squeezes you…what comes out?

Do we falter to the world and trial around us, or does our faith increase even in the struggle?